



Ignites the Fire of Freedom in Jaipur

An introduction to Fedora, an all night hack-fest, getting to know Emacs and developing a website within just a few minutes – the newly formed Jaipur LUG had it all, with their very first FOSS event, FOSJAM 2009.

It's just been about three months since the inception of the Jaipur LUG in March 2009. Yet the activities and workshops organised by LUG-J have taken the town by storm. Install fests and workshops arranged by the LUG members have introduced the city to mainstream open source communities and spread the word of *libre*. And with its many active members from communities like Fedora, Mozilla and WordPress, it wasn't long before LUG-J's major all-India event, FOSJAM (Free and Open Source Software, Jaipur Meet) was organised.

Since it was the first FOSS-related event in Rajasthan targeted at an audience still new to the Open Source ethos, the workshops were more inclined towards hands-on sessions; JECRC (Jaipur Engg College & Research Centre) lent a helping hand by offering their computer labs, with Fedora running on over 90 machines.

The D-Day

FOSJAM received more than 347 registrations and around 280 turned up.

The event started with the 'free software song' performed by Kapil Acharya, a LUG-J member, followed by *Winblows*, an activity that involved bursting balloons printed with the logos of you-know-what. This was a rocking start to the event and all students soon felt the freedom wave sweeping them off their feet as they joined in the singing.

There was a brief introduction of all the speakers at the gathering, followed by a few words from Shakti Kannan and a vote of thanks by Jai Pandya. Then, Kannan (shaktimaan.com) started with his talk, interestingly titled, "*i-want-to-do-a-project-tell-me-how-2-do-it-fedora*" which covered various aspects of netiquette (mailing lists, IRC, forum etiquette) and how to choose a Free and Open Source project.